

Lincolnshire Knee Clinic

Consultant-Led Specialist Knee Care

Patella Rehabilitation Protocols (Phase 1)

Early recovery exercises after patellar stabilisation

Rehabilitation Objectives

Protect the MPFL graft/repair, control patellar tracking, and start early muscle activation without overloading the patellofemoral joint.

1. Static Quadriceps Contractions

- Technique: Sit or lie flat, tighten your thigh muscle, and pull your kneecap upwards. Hold for 5 seconds.
- Frequency: 10 repetitions, 4-6 times daily.

2. Restricted Knee Bending

- Technique: With the brace unlocked/removed (if allowed for exercises), slide your heel back to bend the knee to the maximum degree permitted by your doctor (typically 60 or 90 degrees).
- Frequency: 10 repetitions, 3 times daily.

3. Calf and Hamstring Stretches

- Technique: Use a towel looped around your foot to gently stretch your calf and hamstring while keeping your knee straight.
- Frequency: Hold stretch for 20-30 seconds, repeat 3 times.